

ion inside the product - Aligned to DevOps
- Hierarchy

GitLab Webinars

As a new joiner to get up to speed on your technical skills and observe how more senior team members hold webinars find the Webinars on the CSM Scale Webinar calendar and register/join as participant.

You can also watch the recordings of some of those Webinars on YouTube - GitLab Webinars - GitLab Unfiltered - Playlist.

GitLab.com Playground and Demo space

For self lead training and experimentation you can setup your own playground/demo space on GitLab.com. Find a self-paced guide here:

- Demo Systems Initial Set Up - Project (Private project for GitLab members only)

GitLab Self Managed Playground and Demospace

Many of our prospects and customer choose the option to maintain their own Self Managed GitLab installation based on the reference architecture. To be able to walk in your customers shoes and experience the same possibilities as well as challenges, there is a shared GitLab Omnibus enviroment for CSMs to use.

1. Follow these instructions to get access to the shared Omnibus Instances

1. The Get started administering GitLab Guide is a great starting point

1. You can export a Service Ping data file from the instance and explore product usage data via the Service ping analysis engine

Finding Answers

GitLab is a massive and everchanging Product, nobody can know everything. So it is important to learn how to find answers. These handbook pages might help you with it.

1. Searching GitLab like a pro

1. Researching Customer Questions

SECTION: customer-success/csm/csm-onboarding/shadowing.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

To learn how GitLab CSMs approach customer engagement and planning conversations, a new team member shadows an established, more senior member of the team in a variety of meetings and actions taken related to those meetings.

Senior members of the team should proactively invite new CSMs for shadowing and include them on any prep or follow up that takes place for the call. New CSMs should also feel empowered to reach out to various members of the global CSM team (not just their regional team) to ask to shadow and learn from them. The goal is to get exposure to different types of calls, relationships, ways of working, topics, etc., without the pressure of owning the accounts.

A new hired CSM should (ideally) shadow 2-3 calls with different CSMs from the same region (per week) for the first 2 months, beginning with week 2, to build up experience and knowledge to run customer facing calls. This will also help new CSMs understand processes like how we handle feature requests, product questions, emergency tickets, communication with other GitLab teams etc. The new hire should contact the onboarding buddy in SLACK for guidance on how to best set up the shadow calls within the region. The onboarding buddy is responsible for actively supporting the new hire getting shadow calls scheduled.

Cadence calls

The cadence call is a core element of the CSM's engagement with a customer. There are several elements involved in a cadence call beyond the call itself.

Pre-call prep

It's important to prep for any customer calls in advance to ensure everyone is getting full value out of the synchronous time. To shadow pre-call prep, it involves both shadowing internal calls and shadowing CSMs 1:1 while they prepare.

- SALSATAM call
 - CSMs meet regularly with each of their SAE/AE and SA teams to ensure they are in sync on their efforts to turn prospects into customers, and engagement with existing customers. A new team member will shadow account team meetings to learn about how they should be conducted.
- Creating meeting agenda
- Gathering required information for call (issue follow-ups, creating demos, reviewing gaps in Gainsight entries, etc.)
- Creating calendar invite (if needed)

Customer call

A new team member will shadow cadence calls to learn how we conduct them live.

- Walking through agenda items
- Taking notes
 - The new CSM should take their own notes during the call, paying particular attention to follow-up items, business outcomes and other customer-stated goals and problems to solve, and questions or topics they're unsure of how to address themselves
 - The new CSM should debrief with the established CSM afterward to compare notes
- Answering questions
- Discuss open issues
- Any other items to touch on

Post-call work

After a customer call ends, there are a number of follow-up items that the CSM does to ensure any action items or unresolved questions are addressed. The new team member should shadow any internal calls and shadow CSMs 1:1 while they do this work. The established CSM should be sure to copy and/or tag the new CSM on any correspondence they have in email, issues, or Slack to ensure the new CSM sees the full lifecycle.

- SALSATAM call and/or ad-hoc debrief
- Gainsight entries (logging the call, updating CTAs, etc.)
- Gather items on areas you could not answer on the call
 - Create issues (if needed)
 - Talk to PMs (if needed)
 - Ask questions in Slack (if needed)
- Follow up with the customer on outstanding items

The cadence call is a core element of the CSM's engagement with a customer. A new team member will shadow cadence calls to learn how we conduct them, and will be involved in the pre-call planning and post-call actions.

Account team meetings

CSMs meet regularly with each of their SAE/AE and SA teams to ensure they are in sync on their efforts to turn prospects into customers, and engagement with existing customers. A new team member will shadow account team meetings to learn about how they should be conducted.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/digital-journey/index.md

The following Digital Programs constitute "Customer Success Services" as included with your Subscription to Software, governed by the GitLab Subscription Agreement available at: <https://about.gitlab.com/terms/>.

Digital Programs

Programs are developed using input from CSMs, customers, and other GitLab resources. Our goal is to provide customers with useful ways to serve themselves. We provide the following:

- Onboarding resources for customers
- Survey results
- Stage enablement email series
- Newsletters
- Webinar setup and insight
- Education, best practices, and planning resources for customers and GitLab team members
- Gainsight playbook setup and maintenance

For more information about Customer Programs, including how to request new or contribute to existing programs, or add contacts to Gainsight, see the Customer Programs page.

Onboarding resources

The Onboarding Quick Guide project template will allow customers to self-service the materials provided from the email templates. The following video provides an overview of how to use the Onboarding Quick Guide project template.

- Onboarding Quick Guide project template
- Onboarding Enablement
- Epic
- Email copy for post-onboarding survey

SECTION: customer-success/csm/engagement/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Managing the Customer Engagement

Customer Success Managers will typically manage customer engagements via a GitLab project in the account-management group. This project will be based off the Enterprise or the Commercial Customer Success Plan Template and customized to match the customer's needs as outlined above. The project is pre-loaded with milestones, issues, labels, and a README template to help kick off the project and outline a proof of concept, implementation, and customer onboarding. The following is a short introduction video on GitLab's first iteration of the Customer Success Plan.

Start a new customer engagement

1. Somewhere between step 3 and step 7 of the customer journey sequence, a Solutions Architect should create a project for the customer in GitLab and include a Professional Services Engineer and Customer Success Manager who are best aligned with the customer account. This typically only applies to Enterprise accounts.
2. After the Customer Success Manager has been aligned with the account, they will assign themselves to the "Customer Success Manager" field within Salesforce.
3. The Customer Success Manager confirms that a new customer project has been created based on the Enterprise or the Commercial Customer Success Plan Template. If it hasn't, they need to create it and work with the Account Executive and/or Solutions Architect to complete it. This may have been done by the SA prior to CSM involvement, but if not the CSM needs to create one.
4. Follow the steps in the PLEASE-READ-THESE-INSTRUCTIONS.md file.

Start a customer upgrade engagement

1. After the Customer Success Manager has been aligned with the account, they will assign themselves to the "Customer Success Manager" field within Salesforce.
1. Provided that the customer is part of the CSM-Assigned segment, confirm that the customer project has been created previously during the customer journey sequence, and if not available

create a project for the customer in GitLab and include a Customer Success Manager who is best aligned with the customer account transition. For Commercial accounts, the CSM will determine if it is beneficial to have a customer project.

1. Verify that the project complies with the Enterprise or the Commercial Customer Success Plan Template.

1. Follow the steps in the PLEASE-READ-THESE-INSTRUCTIONS.md file.

Where does a Customer Success Manager fit in?

During the pre-sales process for Enterprise accounts, a Solutions Architect owns the project with assistance from the Account Executive and should include the Professional Services Engineer if there is one assigned. A Customer Success Manager is involved but only for visibility. Until the account becomes a paying customer the project remains in pre-sales. Once the customer has paid, the Account Executive will set up the "Welcome to GitLab" call along with the key GitLab employees (SAE, SA, PSE and Customer Success Manager) and the customer. There is a preloaded issue for this in the project template.

For Commercial accounts, the Account Executive owns the pre-sales process and engages a Solutions Architect as needed. Once the account becomes a paying customer, the Customer Success Manager will create a customer project if it will be useful to their relationship with the customer, and the Account Executive will schedule a "Welcome to GitLab" call with the customer and the Customer Success Manager.

The "Welcome to GitLab" call will introduce the customer to the Customer Success Manager and begin the handover process. The Customer Success Manager will then lead the rest of the call and own the customer project. If the project was created in the pre-sales project under the pre-sales account-management group, then it is moved to a post-sales project under account-management group.

Customer Engagement Tips

1. Make use of the account management projects (Template)

1. Whenever a customer asks a question via email/Slack, kindly prompt them to open a Support ticket or an issue in the collaboration project

- Examples of a Support issue: Reporting GitLab downtime, errors or accessibility problems
- Examples of a Collaboration Project Issue: General questions about product usage, best practices or recommendations, adoption or integration questions

1. Show customers the power of GitLab by using GitLab with them (ex: related issues, tracking milestones, threaded conversations, ability to interact directly with GitLab's product/engineering teams)

1. Make sure you are responding in a timely manner to customer's open issues. When you are prompt to respond, the customer is more likely to continue using the account management projects

1. Have discussions in the public issues as much as possible. If there is a question/discussion point that requires interaction with the GitLab Engineering and Product teams, post it in the public issue, as it most likely benefits everyone reading the public issue.

1. When adding a SFDC link to a public issue, remember to provide feedback to the product managers using the feedback template

1. In-person meetings are some of the most impactful and productive engagements, but they are also the most expensive in terms of time and money. To make sure both parties get the most out of an in-person meeting have an agenda planned well in advance and send the agenda to all parties attending the meeting. Also, if a GitLab E-group member is attending the meeting, an Executive Briefing Doc (internal link) will also be required (see the next section for more details on engaging with an e-group member).

E-Group Customer Calls

Occasionally, a GitLab e-group member (VP or C-level) will be meeting with a customer, for example, as part of an executive briefing, escalation, etc. Please review the EBA handbook page on guidance on how to schedule with the E-Group, specifically the section on customer, prospect, and partner meetings with an E-Group member. There will be a prep call prior to the customer call (typically the day before), and there is an Executive Briefing Document (internal doc link) that must be prepared and shared with the EBA in advance of the prep call, in addition to any materials that will be used during the customer call. Below are some tips to ensure a positive experience:

1. Work on the prep doc and call resources with your account team.
1. Be as thorough as possible about your customer's details (e.g. ARR, of users, tier, renewal date, stages in use)
1. Ensure you answer the 5 W's (who, what, where, when, why) of the meeting and what should be the outcome of the meeting.
 - Make sure that we detail both what GitLab wants out of the meeting and what the customer wants out of the meeting. This is a collaborative partnership that benefits both parties.
1. Be prepared in advance of what you want the E-Group member to do, say, and ask.
1. Have an agenda for the call and ensure everyone knows what they're supposed to do (who will speak when and about what).
1. Add any topics you think the customer may bring up (positive or negative) and advice on how to approach it.
1. Provide links wherever possible (e.g. documentation, feature requests, blockers, etc.).
1. To add a deep-link to the Gainsight Success Plan, go to the CSM Portfolio dashboard, scroll down to the "Success Plans by Account" widget, expand the report (click the square on the top bar of the report), then click the link under the "Success Plan" (not the link in the account name column to the C360); copy and paste this link to the document. It's typically recommended to use the Gainsight direct login, rather than the Salesforce login, for this purpose.

For an example of a prep doc and additional materials that received positive feedback, please visit this internal only Google doc.

Disengaging with a customer

There are situations when a CSM needs to disengage with a customer. Examples include:

- A customer downgrades or churns and is below the CSM alignment threshold
- A CSM has been engaged with a customer below the CSM alignment threshold for a strategic purpose such as a tier upgrade that was unsuccessful

When this happens, it is important to manage the disengagement so that the customer understands the reason, and is clear on who they should communicate with going forward. Here are some

recommendations for how to have this conversation:

- Do it in person (or face-to-face via Zoom), and include the SAE/AE since they will retain the relationship.
- Be honest about the reason. Each situation will be different, and it's a good idea to talk it over with your manager.
- Go over their options for assistance going forward (below).
- Send a follow-up that summarizes what was discussed, including their assistance options.

Recommended options to review with the customer include:

- Troubleshooting, errors, outages, and basic "how to" technical questions should go to Support.
- Complex "how to" and workflow advice should be sent in writing to the SAE/AE. Doing it in writing lets them work with the whole of Customer Success asynchronously to get the best solution.
- If disengagement is due to the customer downgrading/churning, identify the features they will lose access to with the feature comparison page.
- Online resources such as the GitLab documentation, blog, YouTube channels, community forum and other relevant materials that they can for self-serve guidance.

Customer Personas

Customer Success Managers focus on helping customers achieve business outcomes by advising and enabling customers on usage of GitLab features. We are able to do this most effectively when we are engaged with customer personas who are responsible for the capabilities that GitLab provides.

We have defined two key personas that CSMs should regularly engage with and align on outcomes and use cases:

Development Lead

A member of the customer's development or engineering department, in a leadership role. This person is aware of and/or responsible for delivering on customer business objectives related to the customer's software production. They are able to speak to development workflows, and SDLC and DevOps practices and challenges.

Software Security Lead

Has responsibility for the security of the software the customer develops. This person is able to speak to business requirements, objectives, compliance frameworks, etc. that the customer has related to the software they produce. They have knowledge of (and possibly own) the customer's current security scanning & management tools.

Persona Enablement

We have role-play scenarios to practice identifying and gaining access to the defined personas.

Capturing customer personas in Gainsight

Customer personas are attributed to individual contacts in Gainsight when viewing an account. To capture a customer persona, use the following steps:

1. Inside of the account view, click the Contacts link on the left.
1. Switch to List View by clicking the button next to the word "Contacts" at the top of the screen.
1. Search for the contact you would like to update, and click on their name.
1. In their contact record, edit the GitLab Role field and select the persona(s) that apply to them, and then save the field by clicking the check button to the right.

Customer Prioritization

On the Gainsight Attributes section, the CSM can set the priority level per customer with levels 1 or 2, with 1 being the highest. A new CSM-assigned customer coming on to GitLab will default to Pr1 until their onboarding enablement is complete. Pr3 is solely for unmanaged child accounts, and Pr4 is only for our digital customers and not for the CSM-assigned segment, with the exception of the Public Sector that is trialing a CSM-assigned digital customer. Priority definitions vary by CSM segment.

Why do we use a prioritization system?

- To enable focus on customers that have an imminent opportunity for growth or that require near-term risk mitigation
- To ensure that their book of business does not overburden the CSMs
- To give CSM Managers more visibility into the potential workload of their team via more context on the makeup of the overall portfolio
- Used to further segment customers, beyond the Sales Segmentation

The CSM Portfolio Dashboard is used to help highlight and review each client, including their priority level.

Different geos and teams may have different approaches to prioritization, for example:

- All AMER CSM customers are Priority 1.
- Scale CSE account prioritization model is TBA.

Email Templates

The templates provided below can be used for certain outreach efforts to customers to drive engagement. Please note any points in each template that should be personalized and update accordingly.

Initial customer engagement

Subject: The Value of Working with a GitLab Customer Success Manager

> Dear [CUSTOMER],
>

> I hope this email finds you well. I am reaching out to you today as your dedicated Customer Success Manager (CSM) to discuss the value of working with a CSM and how it can benefit you and your business.

>

> As you may know, our primary goal is to help you achieve success with our product or service. As your CSM, I am here to be your trusted advisor and advocate, ensuring that you are getting the most out of our product and that you are satisfied with your overall experience.

>

> Working with a CSM can provide many benefits, including:

>

> - Strategic Guidance: I can provide you with insights and best practices to help you optimize your use of our product and get the most value out of it. We can work together to develop a plan to meet your business goals.

> - Continuous Improvement: I am constantly monitoring your account to ensure that we are delivering the best possible experience. If there are areas where we can improve, I will work with you to identify and address them.

> - Proactive Support: I am here to ensure that any issues or concerns you may have are addressed promptly and proactively. My goal is to minimize any disruptions and keep your business running smoothly.

> - Increased ROI: By working closely with me, you can maximize the value you get from our product or service, resulting in a better return on investment.

>

> I am committed to being your partner in success and ensuring that your experience with GitLab is a positive one. If you have any questions or concerns, please don't hesitate to reach out to me. I am always here to help.

>

> Thank you for choosing GitLab, and I look forward to working with you to achieve your business goals.

>

> Best regards,

> [YOUR NAME]

> Your GitLab Customer Success Manager

SECTION: customer-success/csm/engagement/non-engaged-customer-strategies.md

Gainsight contains a playbook for non-engaged customers that will trigger if:

- The customer has had no engagement (no logged calls or meetings) in over 60 days AND is a priority 1 or 2 customer
- The customer has an onboarding CTA that has been open for over 90 days

This playbook is also available to be manually opened with the 'Risk' CTA Type.

The playbook contains the following steps:

Playbook

1. Sync with SAE/AE on a reach-out strategy

- CSM to day to day contacts
 - SAE to buyers /influencers/ anyone else they have relationships with
 - SDR to any contacts outside of our relationship
1. Create a compelling message (s) : Review objectives of the customer and fashion messaging for 'why' the customer should engage with us. Consider the following:
 1. We know they are migrating from another platform, so offer training & enablement
 1. We know they are interested in xxx so reach out offering to discuss new feature yyy
 1. Review support tickets and build on any conversation that is happening to offer value
 1. Create Triage Issue If no engagement in step 2 (Escalation must occur if PR 1 + no engagement >90 days)
 1. Escalate via the triage issue: At this point the tracking of engagement strategies will live in the Triage Issue. In this issue, loop in a more senior GitLab resource (decide level based on size of customer with CSM Manager) to reach out to someone on the customer side if still no response after 1 month. Craft the email and provide any context on business objectives available to the GitLab senior resource.

Additional strategies to consider

List of sources to review

- SFDC activity history -> find any email responses from the customer about their projects or technical needs, and reply to those contacts asking if they were able to implement, and if they have questions.
- Zendesk tickets
- LinkedIn prospecting (best w/ Sales Navigator). Need to describe this process, how to find the right roles, and best practices for contacting them.
- Any known GitLab usernames, check for activity on issues. Try to follow-up to see if they implemented or found workarounds.
- Google docs meeting notes - look for any Positive Business Outcomes (PBOs) or Required Capabilities, or tech stack mentions.
- Previous Chorus meetings, find people and reasons to inquire if they were successful, ask for a meeting to see how we can help.
- SDRs to help prospect, and alert SAE/AE/SA/CSM on meetings or responses. CSM to give SDR pointers on relevant topics.
- If different from who we normally work with, contact economic buyer from license app or SFDC
- If large enough, ask exec group and board for networking/introductions
- Perform a news search for any major events such as acquisitions, layoffs, product launches

Executive Reachout

Email Templates

Sample Email 1

Hi [XXX],

I hope this finds you well. As an introduction, my name is [YYY], and I lead the global customer success management (CSM) team here at GitLab.

I wanted to get in touch to see how your experience with GitLab has been over the past year,

and to connect on how we can partner to further enable your teams on GitLab. You have available to you a number of workshops and enablement sessions on DevOps best practices that your CSM can facilitate - we are finding our customers are reaching maturity and finding value faster as a result of engaging their broader teams in these sessions.

How would a 30-minute call over the next couple of weeks work to connect on progress to date and look at how we can support you and your team moving forward?

Best,

[YYY]

Sample Email 2

Hello [XXX],

My name is [YYY], and I am the director of global customer success management (CSM) team at GitLab.

I wanted to touch base to see how your usage of GitLab is going and what your experience has been over the past [ZZZ] months. I understand your primary business driver is {a} which will help you achieve {b}. Your CSM can help enable your teams to drive this successfully across your organization.

We would love to have a call with you to work together to plan your continued success, and discuss any questions or concerns you may have.

Thank you, and we look forward to building our partnership with you!

Best,

[YYY]

Additional Items

- Reach out at different times of day and days of the week
- Continue to reach out in staggered manner every 1-2 weeks
- Highlight what benefit they'll get out of the call (make it focused on them, not me)
- Show the value of a CSM, e.g. share new GitLab functionalities that might interest them and that we can share more relevant features once we know more about how they use GitLab
- Have something actionable and specific so they don't have to do as much work (e.g. instead of "when are you free for a call?", ask "are you available Thursday at 2?")
- Just schedule a call and see if they show up (works more often than not .)

SECTION: customer-success/csm/escalations/_index.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Background

Escalations can take at least two different forms:

1. Account Escalation. This occurs when the customer expresses or a GitLab team member identifies that a customer is facing a challenging situation that may or may not relate to a specific support ticket. Anyone in GitLab can open an account escalation and circulate it to the leadership of the appropriate group to find a DRI.
1. Support Ticket Attention Requests (STAR). This occurs when an open support ticket is deemed moving too slowly.

The purpose of this handbook entry is to describe the process for account escalations. Please see the Support Ticket Attention Requests for details on how to request a support ticket escalation. For a detailed walkthrough of the process, please login to GitLab Unfiltered and view this video.

Objective

Define the process for managing account escalations and define a framework for communications, activities, and expectations for customer escalations.

Scope

This process addresses escalations for CS-assigned customers. This process can also apply to other segments if a strategic partnership or relationship exists. Any GitLab team member can escalate an account on behalf of the customer.

Definitions of Severity Levels

Severity Level	Description	Cadence	Levels of Involvement
-----	-----	-----	-----
Critical	Major issue(s) significantly impact customers' ability to deploy or use a solution, risk loss of or use of a solution, high risk loss of a customer or significant contraction, or significant risk to the relationship and brand.	Daily	VP of Sales, Product, CRO, CEO, VP of Customer Success, Global/PubSec CSM Leader
High	Major issue(s) significantly impact a customer's ability to deploy or use a solution, risking current adoption, risk of loss of customer or contraction, future growth on the account, and damage to the relationship.	Multiple times per week	VP of Sales, Product, CRO, CEO, VP of Customer Success, Global/PubSec CSM Leader
Medium	Issue(s) impact a customer's ability to deploy or use the product, risking current adoption and renewal.	Weekly to Bi-weekly	Global/PubSec CSM Leader
Low	Issue(s) impacting a customer's ability to deploy or use the product, risking customer value realization, timeline, customer satisfaction, and adoption levels.	Standard Communication	Regional CSM Manager, Account Manager

- Cadence refers to the cadence of internal and external meetings and communications to the customer.

- Level of involvement defines scope of internal communication and awareness. Others can be

included based on the type of issues involved.

Escalation DRI

The DRI for the escalation is determined by evaluating these options in order:

1. If the escalation is related to an ongoing Professional Services project, the Professional Services Project Manager will be the DRI of the escalation.
1. If the escalation is NOT related to an ongoing Professional Services project and there is a CSM assigned to the account, the CSM will be the DRI.
1. If the customer does not have an assigned CSM but is assigned to TAM Scale (Customer Success Engineering), then the regional CSE leader will be DRI, with CSEs providing technical support as needed.

mermaid

flowchart TD;

A[Account Escalation Identified] --> B{Is this related to a Professional Services Project?};

B -->|Yes| C[Professional Services Project Manager is DRI];

B -->|No| D{Does customer have an assigned CSM?};

D -->|Yes| E[CSM is DRI];

D -->|No| F[Customer assigned to TAM Scale];

F --> G[Regional CSE leader is DRI];

At the beginning of the escalation, the DRI must be determined - the DRI owns the following responsibilities and key steps:

- Overall articulation of the approach to resolution, including ensuring the plan and approach is understood
- Coordination of internal GitLab and customer resources to drive troubleshooting and resolution of the issue
- Management of customer and internal communications, both async and synchronous
- Ownership of next steps, ensuring these are determined, communicated clearly with appropriate timelines to meet the level of urgency

Escalation (For Non Professional Services Projects)

- The DRI is responsible for managing the account engagement (not the ticket), including:
 - Management of internal team and customer meetings for follow-up activities
 - Note: To ensure the DRI does not slow the resolution of issues, the DRI doesn't need to be in all meetings (for example, technical troubleshooting with the customer and support/development)
 - Driving and coordinating the escalation process internally and with the customer, including associated communications and executive-level meetings
 - Opening or reviewing the CS Help - Escalation Support case in Salesforce
 - Managing all assigned escalation tasks in Gainsight
 - Acting as an escalation point for customer-related issues (for example, delayed response, open actions, non-compliance installation or product use, etc.)

- Developing the business case justification and escalation to Product for escalations related to enhancement requests
- Posting updates to Gainsight timeline & keeping the temporary Slack channel and the escalatedcustomers slack channel updated.
- Support Engineering is responsible for:
 - Collaborating with technical resources (for example, Development, Quality Assurance, SREs, and Support Engineering staff) to drive resolution of the technical issues
 - Managing the 24x7 incident resolution and escalation process (Support Engineering, SRE, Development)
 - Supporting executive and customer calls (as needed)

If an escalation is opened as high or critical, and the escalation is product related, a Product DRI is required. Please assign the applicable Product DRI from this list.

What's the difference between an account escalation or an incident escalation?

- This page describes the account level risk meaning the customer impacting issues could be a single incident or an aggregation of issues. The assessment considers impact to the customer, risk to future business with that customer, and GitLab brand.
- Technical Support is ultimately accountable for driving resolution to the support case, including escalation to Engineering, Security, and/or Infrastructure teams. Incident escalation processes should be leveraged for a single incident / support case.
- Declare a GitLab.com Incident if you suspect a widespread issue on GitLab.com
- Escalate an individual support ticket to Support Management for cases with context that necessitate they should be handled outside of standard priority order.
- Have the customer trigger Emergency Support for S1/instance down issues to connect directly with the Support Engineer on-call.
 - You can also page the on-call support manager in cases where you've received word that a customer attempted to raise an emergency, but the on-call engineer was not paged.
- This page outlines the additional support and operational procedures for the varying levels of account escalation.

Initiating, Managing and Closing an Escalation

The following steps are to be taken by the escalation DRI:

Opening the Escalation

Immediately

1. Open or review the CS Help request
 1. If a CSM is the DRI, open the CS Help - Escalation Support case
 1. If a regional CSE leader is the DRI, review the CS Help - Escalation Support case that was opened by an AE, RM, SA, or other GitLab employee who identified the escalation.
1. Create a slack channel to facilitate communication internally at GitLab during the escalation.
1. Identify Escalation DRI and immediate asks

1. Ensure that the escalation is declared in escalatedcustomers.

Within 24 hours

1. Set up and document an internal standup cadence series while the escalation is running and put the details in the escalation case.

Ongoing

1. Post updates in the Gainsight case CTA & Slack channels according to the cadence described in the definitions of severity levels.
1. Keep exit criteria and DRIs up to date in the CS Help request

Temporary Slack Channel

This channel will remain open until the escalation is closed and should be listed in the escalation case. Name the channel escCUSTOMERNAME (must start with esc to be included in our data retention policy) and ensure it is a public channel so that relevant parties can be easily added/find the channel. Some more tips & tricks for opening and managing the temporary slack channel can be found below:

- a. Create an opening message in the escalation channel which should include the link to the escalation case + the initial ask. Also link to the customer notes doc.
 - Example for a potential opening message to get things going:
 - "Welcome! This is the channel for the <CUSTOMERNAME> escalation regarding ongoing performance problems which are impacting the whole user base."
 - The escalation case is ready and available at "<LINK>"
 - The initial ask/need from DRI (CSM) to GitLab management is defined in the escalation case - Quote:
 - "We need a GitLab team (member) who can engage with the customer on a daily basis to further analyze the performance issues root cause(s) and identify potential changes to reduce the performance problems for the users."
 - "Once the root causes are identified, we need a team working with the customer to implement required changes, which may range from configuration updates to changing the architecture of the GitLab platform or involving cloud vendor support for changes in underlying infrastructure."
 - "Whats next?"
 - "Our next sync with the customer team is scheduled for Monday at 10:30am CEST where we would like to have the team (member) defined internally, who can then be introduced to the customer (can be a separate call at afternoon time) to engage in the following days."
- b. If posted, pin the opening message to the channel, so that it is easily available for everyone. Also add the escalation case link as a SLACK channel bookmark.

CS Help Request

If an Escalation (For Non Professional Services Projects) has been identified, create an escalation case in Salesforce. Steps for opening the case:

1. Navigate to the account page in Salesforce

1. Navigate to the next open renewal opportunity under "Opportunities" (Note: if you're having trouble finding the opportunity, you may need to change the Salesforce App. Click the 9-dotted box in the upper left corner and change the Salesforce App to "Sales")

1. In the top right corner, select the "CS Help" button

1. Select the case type: Escalations (CSM/CSE Accounts)

1. Fill out the required fields in the Escalation Case

1. Click "Create case"

1. Complete other fields in the opened case: Customer Escalation Slack channel, Customer Collaboration project, Customer meeting notes, Escalation Exit criteria. At this time, you can also edit any of the fields initially filled out when opening the case.

For a CSM Managed account, the Case Owner will be the assigned CSM. For a CSE account, the Case Owner will be the regional CSE leader.

The Salesforce case will create a Gainsight CTA for that particular customer, which can be found in the Gainsight Cockpit. A sync between Salesforce and Gainsight happens every 2 hours. Once the Gainsight CTA is created, the Case Owner will receive Gainsight notifications to complete required tasks. Data is bidirectional between Salesforce and Gainsight, so changes can be made in either tool. However, all escalation updates must be made in the Gainsight CTA by adding Timeline entries of type "Health Update" (which is the same Timeline entry type used for Red Accounts management).

Internal Standup Cadence

Set up and document an internal standup cadence series while the escalation is running and put the details in the escalation case.

- Major stakeholders from each team involved in the escalation should be invited directly to any calendar invite.
- Post about the internal standup in the temporary slack channel.
- Post the escalation case URL in the temporary slack channel and pin the message so it's easy to find.
- Tip: 10min before each standup, post the link to the escalation case and customer notes doc with a note that the standup will happen at the scheduled time. You can also schedule & automate the message in SLACK.

During the internal cadence, be sure to note any changes in exit criteria or DRI and make those changes in the escalation case.

Identify Escalation DRI and immediate asks

Make sure you write down the initial ask & needs (to initially make progress) in this escalation, as clearly as possible and add a bookmark to it. You can link to it in the initial message within the escalation slack channel. As mentioned, be as specific as possible, as the GitLab exec / management team needs to understand the escalation exit criteria.

For example:

- Required skills (Remote EMEA Timezone)
- Ability to analyze production logs

- Familiarity with large-scale production architecture for GitLab
- Ability to understand SQL queries
- Familiarity with PostgreSQL, Patroni, PGBouncer

Declare the escalation

After the escalation case is opened in Salesforce, you will need to post in the escalatedcustomers channel to declare the escalation. Here's an example message:

- New Escalation
- Customer: "<customername>"
- Slack Channel: "<esccustomername>"
- Meeting Notes: "<LINK: customer meeting notes>"
- SFDC Escalation case URL: "<LINK: escalation case>"
- Severity: High
- Status: Opened
- Product DRI: "Assigned Product DRI"
- Support DRI: "If support involvement is necessary use the @support-manager-oncall slack handle. Please ensure a support ticket is opened with a description of the issue. Support will engage with Engineering by following their RFH process."
- Description: "<Example <Customer> platform is impacted by performance problems since several weeks and users are affected on a daily base which is driving the customer into a critical state. The performance problems are also risking their our license expansion.>"
- FYI: "<TAGYOURMANAGERHERE>"

If the escalation is product related, a Product DRI is required. Please assign the applicable Product DRI from this list. The Product DRI should be added to the esccustomername channel and will drive any product related items throughout the escalation.

Posting in escalatedcustomers

To keep noise to a minimum, posting in escalatedcustomers should happen only at key moments:

- when the escalation is identified and created
- when the escalation is closed or risk reduced to standard business process to manage (that is, issue resolved and monitoring the solution)
- when there is a change in the priority of the escalation

The escalatedcustomers channel is for awareness only and is not intended to replace the dedicated account slack channel, support channels, or the temporary escalation channel. Leverage the temporary escalation channel for daily communication, collaborating with team members, and providing executive updates.

Managing the Escalation

The DRI owns the functions as outlined here:

- If an escalation status significantly changes, make an update in the escalatedcustomers slack channel. Be sure to ping all DRIs involved in the escalation, as well as post in the temporary customer slack channel.

- Update the temporary escalation slack channel daily, at minimum
- The escalation progress should also be communicated to the customer on a regular basis - expectation is 3 or more times a week depending on the situation.

Additionally, please ensure that key escalation updates are captured in the Gainsight Escalation CTA > Timeline > Activity Type = "Health Update". Apply the "Post to Slack - Escalation Update" Timeline template (selectable from top right hand corner of the "Notes" box in Timeline) to ensure consistency of the information presented in escalation updates.

The Gainsight Escalation Update Timeline template questions are :

1. What is the current status of the escalation?
1. What are the next steps in moving the escalation case forward?
1. Who is the owner of the next steps?
1. Has the exit criteria for this escalation changed? If so, what is the new exit criteria?

Tips & Tricks:

- Create a daily reminder (at afternoon before you leave, for example) in your Google calendar just for yourself to update the escalation case + temporary slack channel with latest status/next steps. This ensures everyone is kept informed.
- Depending on the state of the escalation, also think about setting up an internal cadence meeting and include all necessary team members.
 - CSM, AE, SA, CSM & Sales leadership, and potentially other involved stakeholders.

Multiple escalations for one customer

In rare instances, there may be multiple reasons for a customer to be escalated at one time. In order to keep the reasons for escalation and the steps to resolve them focused, there should be an escalation for each situation. Each escalation should be declared and separate Slack channels opened with the relevant stakeholders involved. The reason for the escalation should be included the channel name to reduce confusion (e.g. if one customer is escalated for both a DAST issue and a performance issue, there should be two channels, one called `escustomernamedast` and one called `escustomernameperf`). Each escalation should follow the defined escalation process separately, but the account team and leadership should stay aligned on where the overall account health is throughout and if there should be any action that relates to both escalations. Including additional leadership such as the e-group may be warranted if there is significant risk to the overall sentiment of the account.

Closing the Escalation

- To close an escalation, a clear alignment between GitLab stakeholders and the customer (including documentation in an issue or email) is required. Both parties need to agree the situation is resolved.
- If the customer requests an RCA and the escalation was platform-related, GitLab engineering will lead the RCA and will provide it in writing to the corresponding GitLab DRI, who is managing & closing the escalation.
- When the issue(s) related to the escalation are resolved or move into a non-escalated state:

- Post an Escalation Closure Timeline entry in the Gainsight CTA with the status and resolution. Be sure to use the "Post to Slack - Escalation Closure" Timeline template in the update (selectable from top right hand corner of the "Notes" box in Timeline).
 - Copy that Escalation Closure update and post in the escalatedcustomers slack channel.
 - Archive the temporary Slack channel
 - Update the customer's CSM Sentiment in Gainsight to reflect the new state of the account.
- Gainsight Escalation Closure Timeline template questions:

Please provide a closure update answering the following questions:

1. Did the escalation situation end with a positive outcome, negative outcome, or no outcome?
1. Were the defined exit criteria met?
1. Give a brief summary of the actions of the team that helped close out this escalation ticket

CSM Manager's role in Escalations

The CSM Manager's responsibility is to ensure that the CSM is familiar with the above process and is actively managing the escalation, including the Slack Channel updates and the management of the escalation doc.

When a customer is in an escalated state, the path to resolution must continue to move forward, with both the internal stakeholders and the customer clear on current actions and next steps. The CSM manager is responsible for ensuring that this forward-motion and clear alignment is present and for stepping in and driving action or alignment where necessary.

Engineering's role in Escalations

Engineering support will usually come through Support Engineering, however it's worth noting that under some conditions Engineering / Product may prioritize bug fixes and feature requests related to an escalation.

Product's role in Escalations

At times Product may be needed to support an escalation. This could be due to uncovering a flaw or issue or surfacing feedback to help influence prioritization or workarounds to address the escalations. In most cases CSM and Support will work directly with a PM responsible for the area.

Occasionally, customers will require a product leader to act as a stable counterpart to support an escalation. This will ensure customers don't need to understand how we're organized, or need to get bounced around between PMs during an escalation. To achieve this we will follow this process:

1. CSMs will evaluate each account that reaches a high or critical escalated state, and determine if a Product member is needed.
1. From there, if the escalation reaches a High state a Group Product Manager or Product Director will be assigned. If it reaches a critical state a PLT member will be assigned.
1. During the escalation the GMP+ Product leader will stick with the customer and escalation and operate as a stable counterpart. They will bring in additional PMs as needed to help

address the concerns, but will remain engaged in Slack, and on calls with the customer to be a consistent face and representative of the Product division.

1. Individual PMs may roll in and out of the escalation but the assigned GMP+ product counterpart will remain attached until the escalation is resolved.

CSE's role in Escalations

If necessary, a regional CSE leader will request a CSE to support on an escalation. The CSE should work with the regional CSE leader to determine next steps.

Related Links

- Support Engineering Page and Support Engineering Escalation Procedures
- Product Escalation Issue Template to request Product Team support for roadmap / future needs, prioritization of enhancements and/or issues and troubleshooting of customer issues.
- Customer Health Assessment and Account Triaging

SECTION: customer-success/csm/escalations/infrastructure.md

Infrastructure Engineering Team Process for Incident Management

Please reference Infrastructure's Incident Management Handbook Page for a definitive record of roles & responsibilities, communication and workflow around infrastructure incidents when they occur.

Customer Communications for Infrastructure Incidents

For any incident declared as ~severity::1/~severity::2, an incident review is required. Incident reviews are authored asynchronously in the incident issue, and their workflow is tracked on the Production Incidents Board.

For full detail of the incident review process, please reference Infrastructure's incident review process. CSMs can self-serve updates on SaaS incidents by reviewing the SaaS weekly meeting, the agenda for which, and additional steps for CSMs when a topic is not listed, can be found in the infrastructure handbook section found [here](#).

Customer Success will seek to use the incident issue as the single source of truth (SSOT) and encourage CSMs and their customers to reference the issue for updates. This aims to ensure that duplicated information does not become stale.

In the event that an incident issue is confidential, CSMs should leverage the publicly-available communications such as those shared by the CMOC on <https://status.gitlab.com>.

Immediately following the resolution of an incident, asynchronous work to author an Incident Review is started within the incident issue. Within seven working days, the Incident Review should be complete, and the last Incident Manager assigned to the response is responsible for labelling it appropriately and adding it to the agenda for Infrastructure's

Synchronous Review Meeting

held weekly on Tuesdays, and published in the GitLab Team Meetings calendar.

For S1/S2 incidents where a CSM has reason to believe their customer has been impacted, it is highly recommended that the CSM reach out proactively to their customer(s) to better understand

if and how the customer has impacted and to determine next steps. For most customers, proactive CSM communication, in addition to the platform notifications and incident issue updates, will be sufficient.

Incidents Impacting All Customers

For our top ARR customers or those significantly impacted by an incident, a customer-facing Incident Review

may be requested by the customer or by CSM/GitLab leadership. This customer-facing review should only proceed after the incident has been internally reviewed during a weekly review.

A CSM should interface with the Incident Manager to ensure timelines are clear and to coordinate a

customer-facing meeting. In the instances that a CSM is asked by a customer for an RCA with the GitLab team, or feels that one is required, the CSM is to work with their CSM Manager on next steps. For the sake of efficiency, we seek to keep these meetings to a minimum.

If a CSM or CSMs believe that a written executive summary is required for their customer(s), they are to request this summary of CSM management, who will work with Infrastructure management

to craft the summary and make it available to all CSMs to send to their impacted customers.

Incidents Impacting One or a Small Subset of Customers

When an incident impacts a single or small subset of customers, the relevant CSM(s) are welcome to attend the Tuesday synchronous review meeting to contribute and determine the next steps for their customer.

If at any point in the above scenarios an incident creates the requirement for a customer escalation, the CSM is to follow our defined escalation process.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/_index.md

For an overview of Gainsight, and information about how to login, please refer to the Gainsight Overview Page.

Gainsight for Customer Success Managers

CSMs use Gainsight for a multitude of purposes, including logging their customer calls, updating their call-to-actions (CTAs), updating success plans, and gaining insights on their customer's product usage data.

One of our CSMs created an 8 minute video (internal-only) of her workflow and how she integrates Gainsight into her day to day tasks to reduce the lift and ensure her accounts stay up to date.

The table below represents the steps a CSM would typically take in Gainsight. Please reference each handbook page for further information.

Overview

- Using Gainsight at GitLab
- Gainsight Dashboards
- Customer Programs
- Sally the Slackbot
- Email Assist

C360

- C360 overview
- Account Engagement - Customer Prioritization
- NPS/CSAT
- Customer contacts

Timeline

- Using Timeline
- Cadence Calls
- Customer Renewal Tracking - At-Risk Process

Calls to Action

- Calls to Action (CTAs)
- Executive Business Reviews (EBRs)
- Account Handoff CSM-to-CSM Checklist
- Customer Renewal Tracking
- Customer Renewal Tracking - At-Risk Process

Renewals

- Customer Renewal Tracking
- Customer Renewal Tracking - At-Risk Process

Success Plans

- Success Plans
- Account Engagement - E-Group Customer Calls

Health Score

- Use Case Adoption (definitions)
- Customer Health Scoring

- Customer Health Assessment and Management
- License Utilization

Adoption Score

- CI Adoption Scoring
- DevSecOps Adoption Scoring

Product Usage Data

- Operational Data Vision Page
- Using Product Usage Data in Gainsight
- Product Usage Data FAQs
- Use Case Adoption (definitions)
- Customer Health Scoring
- Product Usage Data - Data Team
- License Utilization
- Maturity Scoring
- Product usage playbooks with usage metrics

Dashboard Metrics

- Time to Value Metrics

Digital Customer Success Programs

- Customer Programs
- NPS/CSAT

Technical Documentation

- Gainsight Technical Documentation
- Gainsight Administration
- Salesforce and Zendesk Sync

Gainsight University

- Gainsight End Users Learning path - Gainsight University

Video enablement

The videos listed here are internal to GitLab only. You will need to be logged in to the "GitLab Unfiltered" YouTube channel to access them.

- Gainsight Overview and Demo
- Gainsight Foundations
- Gainsight Enablement 1: health score, call logging, and creating a success plan
- Gainsight CTAs
- Gainsight CSM Dashboard and Customer 360
- Gainsight Assist Gmail Plugin

- Gainsight Account Triage
- Executive Business Reviews with Gainsight
- How a Gainsight CSM Uses Gainsight
- Using Gainsight in Account Team Meetings
- License Usage in Gainsight
- Product Usage Data - Overview
- At Risk Customer Video

Sally the Slack bot

Sally is an AI powered Slack bot that allows you to log customer calls, update customer data, provide information on health scoring, current risks, and opportunities.

While only Gainsight users can make inquiries with Sally, if she is in a channel and requested for information, her response will be visible to everyone in the channel. As a result, unless you want everyone in the channel to see the information, it's recommended to chat with Sally in a direct message.

To get started with Sally, send her a message that says "help" and she'll let you know what she can do. For more information, see Gainsight's suggested queries and other Sally user guides.

When updating account information, be sure that you select the correct account. Some larger organizations can have multiple entries in Salesforce. Requested updates should be available immediately in Gainsight.

Emails

Gainsight offers a semi-automated email feature called Email Assist, which is accessible to CSMs using Calls to action in the Cockpit. We recommend using Email Assist tasks when CSMs need more control over the scheduling and content of the email. A CSM will select the individual contacts to send the email to, and the email contents can be customized as needed.

A full list of available emails can be found in a GitLab-only Google Doc. In the future, we'll move this information to a GitLab project.

CSMs can send these emails to customers in one of two ways:

1. Directly in Gainsight: To send an email directly from Gainsight, create a basic CTA for the customer with the email subject/purpose. Once it's opened, click on the CTA, click the three vertical dots at the top right, then click "Send Email". Then choose the appropriate email template from the dropdown and fill in the recipient's email address and send.
2. In Gmail through a Chrome extension: Add the Gainsight extension to your Google Chrome browser. Once added, to apply a template, open a blank email and click the "G" icon on the right sidebar, choose the template, and click "Apply template". Complete the email as normal. If a recipient's email address is in Gainsight under their account, it will auto-link any emails and update the account's timeline. See Gainsight's support article on Email Assist for more details.

Please note we recommend BCCing Salesforce on all emails rather than syncing every email to

Gainsight, although it is also possible to BCC Gainsight.

Salesforce and Zendesk syncing

Gainsight is synched with Salesforce so that everything that happens in Gainsight is pulled into Salesforce, allowing Salesforce to remain our SSOT but also allowing us to not have to duplicate information. Gainsight is also integrated and syncs with Zendesk so CSMs can view customer support tickets within Gainsight.

Salesforce syncs are queued at 12AM Pacific Time (7AM UTC). The full sync typically is completed by 4AM PT (11AM UTC). Note that "Last Activity Date" field syncs every two hours (based on "Call" or "Meeting" activity type).

Zendesk syncs are queued to run every day at 12AM Pacific Time (7AM UTC).

If you see a data issue (e.g. account hierarchy, ARR, etc.), check if this is the same information that's in Salesforce. If so, use Salesforce chatter and at-mention sales-support with the items that need to be updated and/or reviewed. If the issue is specifically Gainsight and not sourced from Salesforce, pull in CS Ops.

For information on how we manage the backend data for Gainsight, please see our Go-To-Market technical documentation handbook page.

Updating fields

The CSM Name field in Gainsight indicates which CSM owns a specific account, and determines which accounts will appear for a CSM on dashboards, etc. This field syncs to the Customer Success Manager field in Salesforce. It can only be edited in Gainsight, and any changes to the field in Gainsight will sync over to Salesforce within one minute. If you see any discrepancies between these two fields in the two systems, please report to the CS Ops team.

Account Owner, Solutions Architect, Renewal Date, ARR, subscription and opportunity info, etc. are all updated in Salesforce and synced to Gainsight on a daily basis.

Customer contacts

To add customer contacts to an account, you can add them in either Salesforce or Gainsight, as we utilize a bi-directional sync. It is good practice is to check that any customer contacts we engage with are in Gainsight for the following reasons:

1. When scheduling a meeting, they can be logged in the meeting.
1. If any of these contacts open a Support Ticket, we want it assigned to the account. The contact must be in SFDC for that to work.
1. When we send emails to contacts (monthly release, marketing, etc.), the contact needs to be loaded into Gainsight.
1. To share a Success Plan, they need to be a contact in Gainsight.
1. Sponsor Tracking component requires the contact to be in Gainsight.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/c360-overview.md

For an overview of Gainsight, and information about how to login, please refer to the [Gainsight Overview Page](#).

For an overview of how CSMs use Gainsight, please refer to the [Gainsight CSM Overview Page](#)

Customer 360

The Customer 360 (or C360) is the full overview for each individual account.

The left side panel of the 360 contains the following sections:

- Summary - high-level overview of the account
- Attributes - account-related details and links; for lifecycle stage definitions, see our [vision handbook page](#), and for deployment types see our [definitions](#)
- Scorecard - health score
- Success Plan - success plans
- Account Hierarchy - provides a tree of parent and child account hierarchy if applicable
- Cockpit - holds all of your tasks and CTAs for the account
- Contacts - all contacts for the account (synced from Salesforce)
- Opportunities - open opportunities (synced from Salesforce)
- License Utilization - license utilization
- Product Usage Trends - product usage trends
- Product Usage Scorecard Calcs - shows calculations of product usage health score
- Instance and Namespace Details - instance and namespace details
- Whitespace (Use Case) - use case technology tracking
- Whitespace (Use Case Visual) - visualization of inputs from above report
- Whitespace (Stages until transition) - tracks whitespace information based on stage
- Webinar Participants - gives insight into registrations / attendance for 1:many events (webinars, hands-on labs, etc)
- Survey - holds all survey response data from Journey Orchestrator customer programs
- Program Logs - automatically logs Journey Orchestrator customer program emails to the account history for visibility

If you'd like, you can toggle the "Scrolling" button at the top of any 360 page to enable scrolling through all of the sections, rather than having to click into them.

Note at the top of the 360 page, there is a button for Timeline, which shows all logged activities for that specific customer. Gainsight has a number of options for logging a CSM's interactions with a customer. These are useful to build a historical record of what the customer has done with us, and the initiatives we've worked on.

Following accounts

On each account's 360, there is a "Follow" button next to the account name. If you are assigned as a CSM to an account, there is no need to follow the account, as you will automatically receive all notifications for that account. If you are not the CSM assigned to an account, you can follow the account to receive the same notifications the CSM assigned does.

Referenceable customers

The Referenceable Customers field on the C360 Attributes section highlights if a customer is a Referenceable Customer. If a Customer is not a Referenceable Customer and they would make a great one, follow the process to Nominate a Reference Customer.

NPS and CSAT Scores

For information on customer surveys and how the NPS and CSAT scores are calculated and the types of questions asked, please refer to the NPS and CSAT scores handbook page.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/gainsight/ctas.md

A CTA is a call to action that is tied to a customer and appears in a CSM's cockpit, as well as the account cockpit. CTAs can be created manually at any time, but some will automatically be created for you based on certain events or data.

To create a new CTA, go to your cockpit and click "+ CTA", then fill out the appropriate information. If a CTA will consist of multiple tasks over a period of time, click CTA after saving it, then click the three dots on the top right of the new right sidebar, and click "Add Task". You can add as many as needed and track your progress in the milestone section.

Watch a quick video on Gainsight CTAs to learn how to use them, best practices, and tricks.

Cockpit

The Cockpit is the main place you'll go to manage CTAs, which can be opened from several methods. They can be automatically opened due to trigger points in a customer's lifecycle, a CSM can manually open them, or if a CSM logs a task in a Timeline event that task will populate in the Cockpit.

The main Cockpit is located by using the far left navigation panel (under "Home") and clicking "Cockpit" to see all CTAs for all customers (this can be customized and refined, discussed below).

There are also individual C360 Cockpits for each customer, which can be located by navigating to the Customer 360 and clicking "Cockpit" in the left sidebar. Please note that C360 Cockpits do not include success plan objectives, while the main Cockpit screen does.

The Cockpit can be customized for your needs so that you can see what data is most helpful to you and your workflows.

1. Use the far left nav panel (under "Home") and click "Cockpit" to see all CTAs for all customers

1. At the top right of the screen (below "Cockpit"), you'll typically want to looking at the dashboard called "My CTAs" as it is a comprehensive overview of all CTAs assigned to you (however, you can choose another default view from the list or create your own view with even further customized options)

1. Click the "Due Date" dropdown button at the top right next to the search field to change the groupings of the CTAs as desired (you can group by Type, Company, Renewal Date, etc.)
1. Click the "+" button at the right of the column names, which will tak